

Another key feature is the page-zoom feature, which allows you to zoom in to the entire document, instead of just the text. The developer shortcuts to turn off stylesheets and images are also useful. In other browsers, you have to go through multiple menus or use bookmarks for this functionality.

One of the growing concern with browsers these days is vulnerabilities on the security front. Opera is one of the most secure browsers, and there haven't been any major security flaws in Opera's history. However, this makes it a bit weak on page display. Though rendering is excellent and the text never gets crooked regardless of the size of the window frame, sites with Flash, advanced HTML or Java content won't always be displayed correctly. This is being fixed, though, and later versions should have better displays for pages with such content.

Like Firefox, Opera is a clear winner on the interface and appearance side. It has both advanced and basic features well laid out throughout; the toolbars and keyboard shortcuts can be used effectively to perform most tasks. The only thing that holds back everyone from using Opera is the sheer number of features available!

Maxthon 1.2.4

In early 2000, Internet Explorer 5 was the best browser in the world. It rendered pages pretty well, had a nice interface and was fast. IE6 was released soon after with a few, relatively minor fixes, and cemented IE's stranglehold on the Web browser market. However, this dominance made Microsoft complacent and today, IE6 is a below-average browser.

Unfortunately, most Web pages seem to like its Web engine as they do not display optimally on browsers such as Opera and Firefox. This is where the MyIE2 team has come to the rescue. They developed Maxthon, which is based entirely on the IE engine, but which comes with better integration of plug-ins, security fixes, and last but not least, tabbed browsing.